

MEDIAN AGES AROUND THE WORLD

The median age is the age that divides a population into two equal groups, so that half the people are younger than this age and half are older. The lower the median age, the younger the population. The median age for the entire world is 31 years.

Years

15–20	30–35	No data
20–25	35–40	
25–30	40+	

Population pyramids

A population pyramid plots the sizes of age groups within a population. A pyramid showing a young population shows a country where families are large but life expectancy is low. Populations age when life expectancy increases and when people have fewer children.

Greenland

The median age here is 34.3. More than 70 percent of people are ages 15–64. Population growth is just 0.19 percent.

Canada

Canada's population—median age 41.2—is aging, with about 16 percent over the age of 64.

United States of America

The US population's median age is 38.3 years. About 18.5 percent of people are ages 0–14. The population grows by 0.35 percent each year.

Mexico

In Mexico, where 26.2 percent of the population is age 0–14, the median age is 29.2 years.

Guatemala

This is the youngest population in Central America, with a median age of 22.9.

United Kingdom

With a median age of 40.5 years, the UK has an aging, but still-growing, population.

Tunisia

This African country has the highest median age, at 32.8, followed by Morocco (29.5) and Libya (28.8).

Africa

This is the continent with the youngest population, with a median age of 19.7.

Paraguay

Paraguay's median age of 26.3 years is the lowest in South America.

Uruguay

This is the country with the highest median age in South America, at 35.8 years.

Young and old

Poorer developing nations tend to have younger, faster-growing populations than wealthier developed countries, whose populations are aging and sometimes even declining.